

Rise of the phoenix

Researchers at the university of Pennsylvania have developed a robot that can rebuild itself as required. Perfect for space exploration.

Unfriend that sneaky little rat!

Arizona State University have developed a system for predicting which of your friends are more likely to leak private information about you

Bazaar

Zotac Zbox Nano Plus AD10

A neatly packed small wonder!

ZOTAC scores another win with this mini PC. Known for packing in many features into the Mini-ITX form factor, ZOTAC has managed to up the ante with the ZBOX NANO PLUS which makes use of a Nano-ITX (12 cm x 12 cm) board. Few people are aware of the Mini-ITX form factor, even fewer will know about the nano-ITX. The glossy black surface of the ZBOX with aluminium sides seems quite similar to Apple's theme, however, this is much smaller than the Mac Mini.

Also included is a Media Centre Edition remote control and an infrared receiver.

What really caught our attention was the base of the unit. It's actually a standard VESA mount.

So if you have a monitor which accords to the VESA standard then you can attach the base onto the back of your monitor and the ZBOX NANO will easily latch onto it. You can convert your monitor into an All-In-One with this. They might as well market it as such. It features 2 USB 3.0 ports and an eSATA port too. So HD movies can easily be played via an external without any jittering. It only has a single



module in single channel mode but one doesn't need more than that for a media PC.

It's quite easy to access the memory and HDD, unscrew 4 thumb-screws on the bottom and the VESA mount plate comes off. You can easily upgrade your drive and memory capacity. One might assume that the unit could heat up considerably given the small form factor, however, the unit is surprisingly cool for the technology it houses.

There are multiple models of the ZBOX NANO available, we got the AMD model with 2 GB RAM and 320GB HDD. This is a great HTPC option due to its super tiny form factor.

Mithun Mobandas

Specifications

CPU: AMD E-350 1.6GHz;
GPU: AMD Radeon HD6310;
RAM: 2GB DDR3 1066MHz;
HDD: 320GB; **LAN:** Gigabit Ethernet; **Wi-Fi:** 802.11 b/g/n;
Bluetooth: 3.0; **Dimensions:** 127mm x 127mm x 45mm;
Audio in/out, HDMI, Display Port, eSATA, 2x USB 2.0, 2x USB 3.0, Kensington Lock, MMC Slot; **Warranty:** 1-Year.

Contact

Neoteric Informatique Ltd.

Web site: <http://www.zotac.com>

Contact: +91-9891282522

Price: ₹00,000

7.5
10

Features	7.5
Performance.....	7.0
Build Quality	7.0
Value for Money	8.0

ASUS Matrix GTX 580 Platinum Card

More power to the gamers

Specifications

Core Clock: 816 MHz; **CUDA cores:** 512; **Video Memory:** 1536 MB GDDR5; **Memory Interface:** 384-bit; **Ports:** 2x DVI, 1x HDMI, 1x DisplayPort

Contact

ASUS Technology Pvt. Ltd.

Email: reachus@asus.com

Web site: www.asus.in

Contact: 1800 209 0365

Price: ₹30,000

8.0
10

Features	8.0
Performance.....	8.5
Build Quality	9.0
Value for Money	6.5

The GeForce GTX 580 is a beast in itself when it comes to performance and with ASUS branding it under the ROG series, what you get is a monster card. That the Matrix GTX 580 is factory overclocked is a given. What adds to aura



around the card are the features surrounding it. First thing that strikes you is the size - its a triple slot card. Just

beneath 8-pin power connectors, you will notice three buttons which include two voltage tweaking buttons (denoted by + and - sign) for performance optimization. There's a utility called GPU Tweak which eases overclocking the card. The card glows in various colours to indicate load.

The Matrix GTX 580 is overclocked by 44MHz from its reference settings. We tested the card using an ASUS X58 Sabertooth board along with Intel Core i7-980X processor and 4 GB DDR3 Kingston HyperX RAM.

As expected, the Matrix GTX 580 came out with flying colours.

Synthetic benchmarks such as 3D Mark 11 gave an overall score of 2179 at Extreme settings (1080p) and Unigine Heaven 2.5 gave 41.5 FPS at 1920x1200, Extreme tessellation. The overclock gives around 10 percent increase in the scores across gaming benchmarks. Crysis Warhead gave 49 FPS at 1920x1200 at Very High settings. STALKER: Call Of Pripyat and FarCry 2 both gave a 10 per cent increase in benchmarks at 1080p. Over ASUS's own GTX 580, the Matrix GTX 580 gives about a 12-15 FPS jump in certain games on same settings.

Pricing is quite high at ₹30,000. But then, this is meant for hardcore gamers who spend the extra buck for added features.

Nimish Sawant